5. Project Development Phase

5.1 Development Overview

The development phase implements the planned Incident Lifecycle Automation solution in the ServiceNow Developer Instance.

The implementation begins by establishing the service hierarchy and then creates and processes a sample Corporate VPN incident through multiple stages of the Incident Management lifecycle.

5.2 Step 1 – Create Service

A new Service named **Remote Access** is created.

Configuration

- **Name:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

Purpose

The service represents the remote access capability provided to users and acts as the parent service for the Corporate VPN service offering.

5.3 Step 2 – Create Service Offering

A Service Offering named **Corporate VPN** is created under the Remote Access service.

Configuration

- **Name:** Corporate VPN
- **Parent:** Remote Access
- **Operational Status:** Operational

Result

The service hierarchy becomes:

Remote Access

└— Corporate VPN

This hierarchy can be used when associating incidents with the affected service.

5.4 Step 3 – Create Incident

A new incident is created from the Service Operations Workspace.

Incident Details

Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN from home office

Caller: Michael Hoefer

Assignment Group: Service Desk

The incident is saved and becomes the central record for the demonstration.

5.5 Step 4 – Classify Incident

The incident is updated with detailed classification information.

Incident Details

Field	Value
Description	Michael advised he was able to connect yesterday evening, but this morning received an authentication error. The Internet works fine.
Channel	Phone
Category	Network
Subcategory	VPN
Urgency	2 - Medium
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN
Configuration Item	Selected appropriate CI
Work Notes	Classified and assigned incident

The incident is then assigned to the current user for further processing.

5.6 Step 5 – Knowledge Integration

Agent Assist is opened from the incident.

Knowledge Articles are enabled and relevant articles are reviewed based on the incident's short description.

An appropriate knowledge article is opened and marked as **Helpful**.

The article is then attached to the incident with the comment:

Follow the Steps and Resolve the Incident.

Validation

The following are verified:

- Knowledge article appears in the incident activity.
- Helpful indicator is recorded.
- Knowledge article is associated with the incident.

5.7 Step 6 – Watch List and Reassignment

The incident's tracking information is updated.

Watch List

A support member is added to the Watch List so that they can monitor incident updates.

A user is also added to the Work Notes List to receive work-note updates.

Reassignment

The Assignment Group is changed from:

Service Desk → Network

The Assigned To field is verified to clear automatically after changing the assignment group.

This transfers responsibility to the appropriate Level 2 support team.

5.8 Step 7 – Level 2 Investigation

A Level 2 Network support user accesses the incident through Service Operations Workspace.

The technician assigns the incident to themselves and verifies that the necessary information is available.

Investigation Checks

- Incident description is visible.
- Knowledge information is available.
- SLA information is visible.
- Related records are accessible.
- Incident ownership is assigned correctly.

This demonstrates collaboration between Service Desk and Level 2 support.

5.9 Step 8 – Change Handling

The Configuration Item is updated according to the project scenario.

The incident is then moved to:

State: On Hold

On Hold Reason: Awaiting Change

This represents a situation where an infrastructure/service change is required before the incident can proceed toward resolution.

5.10 Step 9 – Create Child Incident

A child incident is created from the parent incident through the Related Records section.

Child Incident

Short Description: Unable to connect to Corporate VPN

Caller: Another affected user

Description: User receiving VPN authentication failure error.

The child incident number is recorded and the parent incident is checked to verify that the child incident appears in the related records.

5.11 Step 10 – Document Probable Cause

The probable cause is added to the incident.

Probable Cause:

PowerEdge service was suspended and required restart.

This provides structured documentation explaining the underlying cause of the incident.

5.12 Step 11 – Document Resolution

The resolution information is recorded.

Resolution Code

Workaround provided

Resolution Notes

Restarted VPN-SRV-02 service as per emergency change request.

The incident is then moved to the **Resolved** state.

5.13 Step 12 – Create Knowledge Article

A knowledge article is generated from the resolved incident.

Configuration

- **Knowledge Base:** IT
- **Template:** Standard

The incident details and resolution information are reviewed before saving the article.

The Related Records section is then checked to verify that the knowledge article has been created.

5.14 Step 13 – Final Validation

The complete incident lifecycle is validated.

Validation Checklist

Validation Item	**Expected Result**
Parent Incident	Resolved
Child Incident	Resolved / appropriately tracked
Resolution Activity	Available in activity history
Change Request	Linked/traceable
Knowledge Article	Created

SLA	Visible in related records
Service	Remote Access
Service Offering	Corporate VPN
Support Group	Network
Resolution Information	Documented

5.15 End-to-End Development Flow

The completed implementation follows:

Remote Access Service

↓

Corporate VPN Service Offering

↓

Create Incident

↓

Classify Incident

↓

Agent Assist / Knowledge

↓

Reassign to Network

↓

Level 2 Investigation

↓

Awaiting Change

↓

Child Incident

↓

Cause Identification

↓

Resolution

↓

Knowledge Article Creation

↓

Final Validation

5.16 Development Outcome

The development phase demonstrates an end-to-end Incident Management scenario in ServiceNow.

The implemented process connects Incident Management with:

- Service Management
- Configuration Management
- Knowledge Management
- Change Management
- SLA Tracking
- Related Incident Management

The result is a structured incident lifecycle in which an issue can be created, classified, investigated, escalated, associated with supporting records, resolved, and converted into reusable knowledge.